

## 2 Android Basics

At one point in the not-so-distant past, cell phones were primarily used to make and receive phone calls and text messages, and of all the wondrous things your Android can do, these basic functions should be handled the first. The Phone shortcut on the central home screen simply links you to the Phone tab inside the Contacts application. On the next screen you'll see four tabs on top for Keypad, Call Log, Favorites and Contacts. The Keypad is like any other 12-button touchpad with a bottom row containing three buttons, usually a green call button to make the connection (same as hitting your phone's call button), a backspace/delete key and one as a shortcut to sending texts or dialing voicemail.

The exact details may differ as per your manufacturer but the functions will mostly stay similar. For instance, an HTC has a permanent 'Phone' button on the home screen and a slightly modified dialer setup where your recently used contacts appear above the keypad and when you type out the first few letters of a contact's name, their name comes up in the list above the keyboard.



A convenient touch dial pad

### 2.1 Call Log

The Call Log, also called Recent on some models, keeps track of all incoming, outgoing and missed calls, indicated clearly by colour-coded arrows. For faster dialling, you can select any number from this list and hit the green phone icon to connect. Pressing and holding on a particular entry pops open a menu with various options that allow you to edit the number before calling, send a text message, add to your contacts or remove it from the call log. Using the Clear Call Log option from Menu you can clear out all the calls and start re-building the log. Another tab on the tab takes you to Contacts and Favorites which are both discussed in the next chapter. If you have used Gmail, Google Talk, or any other service to send or receive messages, you've already created a list of Google contacts and making and receiving calls and SMSs on your phone keeps adding new names to this list. Even if you do not